

The Stars Hold All The Answers

Mute Testament To Mankinds Foray Into The Unknown...



**MASS
EFFECT™**

Michael Browne

Designing games for a console and porting them to a PC hasn't been much of a success. *Mass Effect* was birthed as an X360-only title developed by hallowed RPG demigods BioWare. The merits as well as shortcomings of the console version are the prime binaries behind this port, and I feel the PC version is better!

The success behind *Mass Effect* across platforms, lies in the epic proportions

of its plot, and the way the story unwinds as you play. From your rise from a mere grunt in the armies of the Human Alliance Military to *Commander Shepard* (you can't change your surname in the character customisation!), and the acquisition of *Spectre* status, to the commanding of your very own state-of-the-art vessel the *Normandy*, the promise of a juicy plot rife with surprises and ripe with opportunity is just too good to pass up.

Here's a plot summary—Several hundred years in the future, mankind has

discovered alien technology on Mars that open up possibilities of interstellar travel. We humans are the youngest members of the Galactic Council, a UN-like organisation populated by dozens of other more advanced alien species. Perceived as ambitious upstarts, humanities first great achievement as a member of the council is your admission into the spectres, a highly elite group of individuals who operate independently, and often outside the bounds of the law, to protect the council's interests. When a spectre named Sarin goes rogue,